

Electricity



Did you know?

One flash of lightning has the same power as 50 million batteries!



Electricity is a kind of energy. It is useful because it can be made easily, then sent into homes where it provides heat, light, and power.



Coal

Fuel

Coal, oil, and gas are all used in power plants.

Oil



Gas

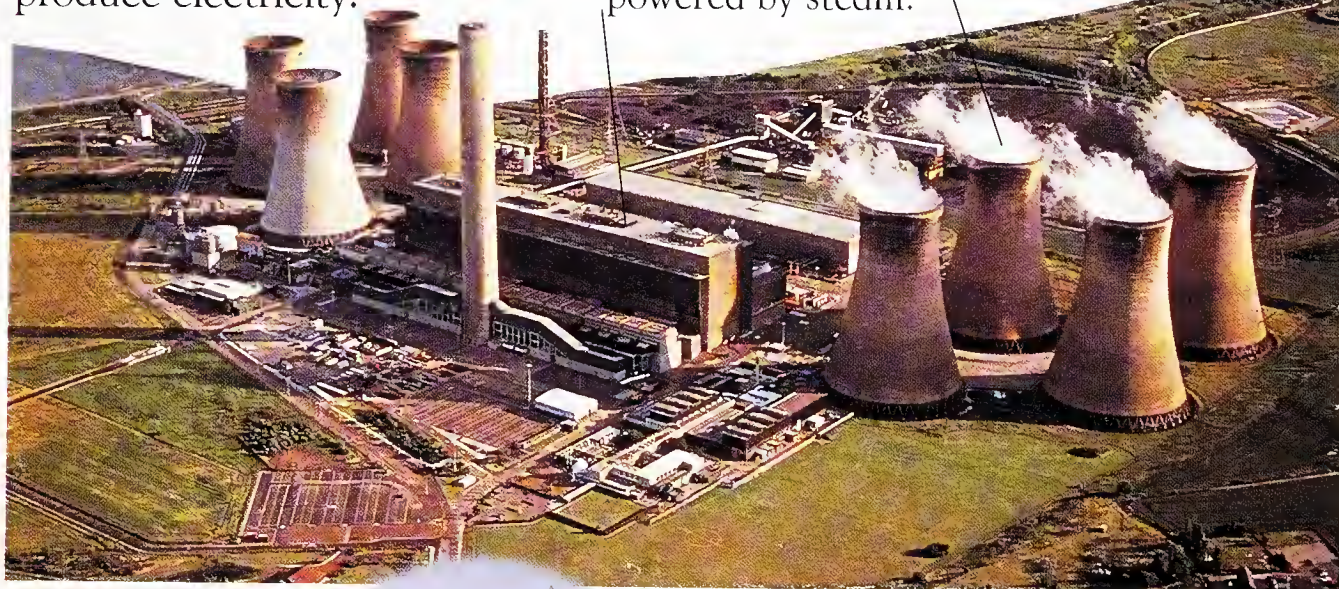


Coal-fired power plant

Power plants burn coal to heat water and make steam. The steam turns turbines, which produce electricity.

Turbines in the main building are powered by steam.

Steam escapes through chimneys.



Tower

From the power plant, electricity is transported along wire cables supported by towers.



Electricity cable

In towns, most cables are buried underground. A few are carried on small poles.



Lightning

Lightning is a kind of electricity. It is as natural as wind and rain.



Battery power

Batteries contain chemicals that make electricity. Batteries are used to power things like toys and flashlights.



Battery-run car

Battery



Types of energy

Different types of energy can be used to make electricity.

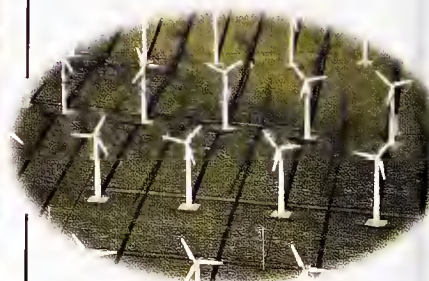


Hydroelectric dams

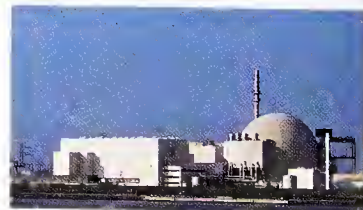
use the power of running water to make electricity.



Solar power uses the sun's light rays to produce electricity.



Wind turbines have huge sails that turn in the wind, helping make electricity.



Nuclear power plants use chemical reactions to make electricity.

